



From Putting India on Wheels to Driving 'Make in India'

Almost two-third global production of Suzuki comes from Maruti Suzuki India Ltd, says MD & CEO Hisashi Takeuchi

BY KARAN DHAR



WHEN JAPANESE CARMAKER Suzuki partnered with the Indian government in the early 1980s to roll out small, affordable cars under the Maruti badge, few would have imagined that India would become the Japanese automaker's biggest export hub and account for two-thirds of Suzuki's global production four decades later.

Maruti Suzuki produced a record 2.3 million cars and SUVs in FY26, about 2,00,000 more than the next three carmakers combined. It exported 4,47,000 vehicles in FY26, up 34% over the previous year—cornering a whopping 49% share in passenger vehicle exports out of India.

"In the first quarter of FY27, our share of passenger vehicle exports has risen to 55%," Hisashi Takeuchi,

managing director and CEO of Maruti Suzuki, tells *BT* in an interview.

In 2025, Suzuki became Japan's top car importer, thanks to Made-in-India SUVs, including the Fronx, the Jimny and the e-Vitara. "Since we are producing cars in India and exporting to Japan, Suzuki became the biggest importer of cars from abroad," says Takeuchi.

Thanks to strong domestic demand and robust exports, almost two-thirds of the global production of Suzuki Group now comes from India, he adds.

To meet rising demand for domestic sales and exports, Maruti Suzuki is expanding at breakneck speed. It added 5,00,000 units of capacity in the first four months of FY27, taking its annual capacity to 2.9 million units. By FY31, the company is targeting annual capacity of four million units, with 8,00,000 units reserved for exports.

Few companies have shaped India's manufacturing story as significantly as Maruti Suzuki. After spawning industrial clusters around its plants in Haryana's Gurgaon and Manesar, the automaker's 640-acre facility in Gujarat's Hansalpur, set up at a cost of ₹25,289 crore, brought about 100 auto parts suppliers to the western state. "When we started production at Hansalpur, it was a big challenge because our supplier locations were mainly in Haryana. Hundred suppliers came and built their factories in Gujarat because transportation cost is reasonably big. They understand that there is economy of scale. We have gradually expanded our production at Hansalpur from 250,000 to 1 million. For them it made sense to open a new factory," says Takeuchi.

Hansalpur is not the only plant with annual capacity of one million units. Maruti Suzuki is also doubling capacity at its 800-acre facility in Haryana's Kharkhoda to one million units once it becomes fully operational. The carmaker has already acquired land for ₹4,940 crore for its second plant in Gujarat's Sanand. The 1,750-acre facility, which is coming up with an investment of ₹35,000 crore, will also have a capacity of one million units.

"The Sanand plant is expected to create 25,000 jobs and it will have facilities such as dormitories," says Takeuchi.

Even though Maruti Suzuki has lost some market share to homegrown rivals in recent years due to its limited SUV portfolio, the carmaker was quick to recalibrate its strategy. "We had only two SUVs in our portfolio in 2021 but now we have six. We have much bigger vehicles which were not there in the past," says Takeuchi. Maruti Suzuki's market share in the SUV segment has jumped from 11% in FY22 to 21% in Q1 of FY27.